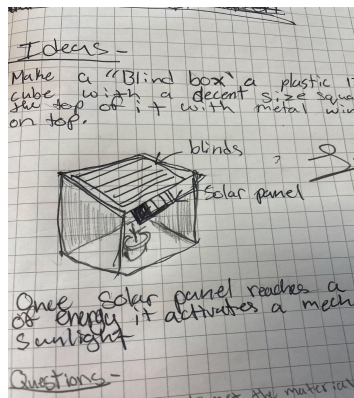


The main problem was that plants were either getting too much sun or too little. Plants would die from way too much sun, and would die from not enough sun. So we needed to figure out a design that would provide shade for a plant when needed and would be able to provide sun at certain times too. Our process of finding a solution was looking at prior solutions, or thinking about things that could provide shade to certain areas. We all came up with our own designs and picked which one would be most efficient by voting. Our prototype design was a box that had blinds on the top of it that would open and close at a certain time of day. The blinds were originally supposed to be stainless steel but we changed them to regular house blinds, and the box was originally supposed to be made out of a hard plastic but we changed it to wood.



We went through a tough process to try and get results we actually liked. We had to use wood because plastic wouldn't have been shipped into the school in enough time. The first time we tried making a prototype we measured wrong and had to start all over because it wasn't big enough to fit the black pant tray in. The second time our wood started to crack and break because of how brittle it was, so we had to start all over again. The third time we used harder wood and pre-drilled out holes before putting the screws in the wood. After we finished putting the box together we discovered we had to make a door to open the box to put the plant in. After all that we decided to paint the box black with some spray paint. Then we tried testing it and the motor didn't work because the battery was too weak, then when we tried a stronger battery it was too strong so it would spin too fast. We were going to order some type of battery that would be just perfect but we ran out of time.

Based on our experience while working on this project future designers should definitely try and test it as much as possible and make sure you can consider possible things that might go wrong when you test it so you can try and prevent possible issues. And you should also never give up no matter how many times you have to start over and I really think our project shows that saying.